

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6
 ♥ Q 4 3 2
 ♦ 5
 ♣ K Q 10 4 2

♠ 7 4 3

♥ J 6

♦ A J 10 7 2

♣ 8 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 9 2

♥ 10 9 8

♦ 4

♣ A J 9 5 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ A K 7 5

♦ K Q 9 8 6 3

♣ -

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♦
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	6 ♦
All Pass			
6 ♦ by South			

South is to play 6 ♦. West leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=0 Total = 4

You don't really have 2 ♥ losers since both of them can be ruffed in dummy. The 2 ♠ losers are real, though, and must be dealt with. If East holds the ♠K then a simple finesse will win the contract for you. A 50% chance. But there is more to this Deal than a simple finesse, look at it carefully.

In addition to the trumps, dummy has another useful card, the ♥J. You can give yourself a second chance by playing West to hold the ♥Q.

Ruff the opening ♣ lead, pull trumps with the ♦K, (they split 1-1), and play a low ♥ toward the ♥J. West fidgets, then puts on the ♥Q and plays another ♣ which you ruff.

You are in control now. You play a ♥ to dummy's ♥J, then a ♠ back to your ♠A. Discard dummy's 2 ♠ losers on the ♥ A K and claim your slam.

Suppose that it was East who held the ♥Q. Your ♥J would have been taken and you wouldn't get the two ♠ discards.

Then you would have to rely on the ♠ finesse after all. You'd be no worse off because you could still discard one of dummy's ♠s on a big ♥.

This method of play gave you two chances instead of just one.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ Q 6 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ 8 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ K 7

♦ A J 10 8

♣ K J 9 6



♠ 6 4

♥ 10 9 5 4 2

♦ 7 6 4 2

♣ Q 5

♠ A Q 5 3

♥ A J 8

♦ K Q

♣ A 10 7 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass	4♣	Pass	2NT
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Pass	7NT		4NT
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All Pass

7NT by South

♥Q. Two chances.

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠10.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=2 ♦=4 ♣=2 Total = 12

A. Conan Doyle would have called this "The Tale of Two Queens". You need to find one more trick and to do so you are going to have to find either the ♥Q or the ♣Q. You can finesse East for the ♥Q, and you can finesse either defender for the ♣Q.

So which will you choose?

Neither, yet. First take your 8 winners in ♠s and ♦s, hoping somebody discards something to help you. They don't.

Now play the ♣A, then ♣K, hoping the ♣Q falls. If she does you have your thirteenth trick in ♣s. If she doesn't you take the ♥K then finesse East for the

As you see, the ♥ finesse would have failed. You might have guessed the ♣Q correctly, but you might not have.

It always pays to look for a second chance. Here you try to drop the ♣Q, and if it doesn't work you have the finesse for the ♥Q in reserve.

Why not try to drop the ♥Q and keep the finesse for the ♣Q in reserve? Because you and dummy had 8 ♣s between you and only 6 ♥s. So the ♣Q was far more likely to be doubleton than the ♥Q.